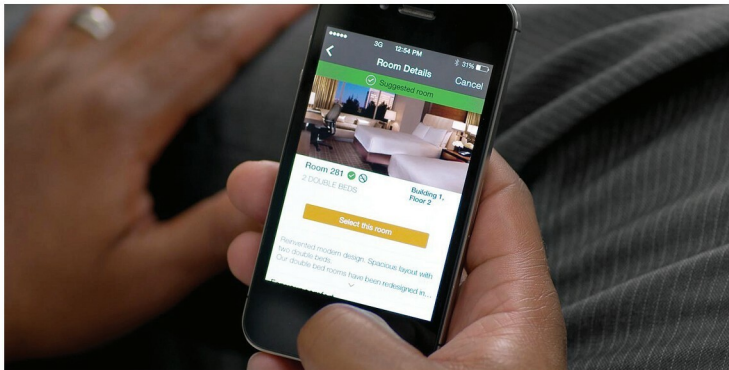


Creating a Digital Booking App in App Inventor 2

Going to popular restaurants can be fun provided one has a reservation. Waiting in a queue for a table can be a real dampener. So let's create an app that can make reservations on our behalf, taking our entertainment experience to a higher level.



This Android learning journey has become exciting, with readers providing continuous feedback and support by coming up with new challenges and problems all the time. It's been almost two years now since we started out on our Android journey with pretty basic topics and, over time, we have tackled complex scenarios as well. Going forward in the series, we move on to a more advanced topic.

Going to restaurants has become pretty common nowadays. Every weekend you can see crowds of people having a good time in these places. With large crowds, there is the issue of waiting lists and queues, which can become a real pain for restaurant managers. Restaurants allow advance bookings over the phone, but why not make this service a little more digital and book your table from your mobile app instead? So this is what we will attempt in this session. We will create a restaurant reservation system that will help both customers and the restaurant managers to avoid long queues.

In the previous tutorial, we created a Web database using the open source cloud-enabled Firebase. In this tutorial, we will use this previously acquired knowledge to deliver a fully working digital booking application. Hope you are well versed with the topics covered so far.

If you have missed the last tutorial, I'd like to revise things quickly. Let me first introduce you to Firebase, which

is a Google provided cloud database that is open source and freely available for use.

Features of Firebase

Listed below are some of the key features of Firebase.

1. Firebase uses the GUI based data centre so that you can view all the entries and manage them as well.
2. Being on the cloud, it is accessible on-the-go from any device.
3. Smart authentication provides secure access.
4. The real-time database reflects changes as soon as the data is updated.
5. Collaborators can be added so that multiple people can manage the database.
6. No coding is required for fetching and storing data.

Creating a project in Firebase

1. To use Firebase, you must have a working Google account. I hope you have one, as it will be needed to run App Inventor.
2. Type <https://console.firebase.google.com/> in the address bar of the browser you are using and hit *Enter*.
3. If asked for login credentials, give those of your Google account and proceed.